Executive Summary

Solution and Recommendations

1. Problem Statement

Problem Statement 1 – Mall 2.0: Turning Flagship Retail Stores Into Hyperlocal Fulfillment Hubs

2. Team Details

Team Members:

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College/University:

- KIIT University

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3. Solution Summary

Proposed Solution: MallAI – Phygital Premium Shopping Assistant

We propose **MallAI**, an AI-powered phygital solution that unifies in-store experiences with hyperlocal fulfillment.

Dual Mode for Customers -

1. **Physical Mode:**
   - App guides the customer inside the mall to the **exact floor, section, and rack** of the product.
   - Reduces search time, enhancing in-store experience.
2. **Online Mode:**
   - Provides a **virtual tour of the store** (via pre-recorded catalog and live staff video assistance).
   - An **AI assistant** offers product details, quality feedback (based on ratings), and personalized recommendations.
   - Orders are packed in-store and **delivered by brand-trained staff**, maintaining premium value and packaging.

Operational Enhancements -

Inventory Visibility:
Integration with store **POS/WMS systems** ensures real-time stock updates for both online and offline customers.

Lean Back-End SOP:

- Dedicated picking slots (e.g., every 30 mins) for online orders.
- AI-assisted batching of orders to reduce staff movement.
- Separate packing zone in backroom to avoid disturbing walk-in experience.

Go-To-Market:

- Premium/high-value items delivered by **brand staff** to maintain aesthetics.
- For other SKUs, optional integration with trusted premium last-mile partners.

4. Key Assumptions

The success of **MallAI** relies on the following assumptions:

- Indoor navigation maps or QR codes are provided by malls.
- Stores allow integration of POS data with the MallAI platform.
- One or two staff per store can be trained for picking/packing during pilot.
- Customers are willing to use the mall's unified app for navigation and online assistance.

5. Final Recommendations

We recommend the following steps to maximize the impact of **MallAI** :

1. **Pilot in one premium mall:** Implement MallAI in 2–3 stores (e.g., cosmetics, footwear) to validate flow and costs.
2. **Refine operations:** Gather data on picking times, online order volume, and customer feedback.
3. **Scale across malls:** Expand MallAI to multiple premium outlets with improved app features and staff SOPs.

Summary

We believe MallAI transforms malls from passive retail spaces into active hyperlocal fulfillment hubs, preserving the premium experience while unlocking new revenue opportunities.